

Chris Ernst

Senior Product / UX Designer | chris@chrisernst.me | 678-378-8040 | chrisernst.me

SUMMARY

Senior Product and UX Designer with 9+ years of experience designing enterprise software, restaurant technology, inventory management systems, and omnichannel service experiences, including work on NCR's Aloha platform, used by 100,000+ restaurant locations worldwide. Proven track record leading end-to-end product design across discovery, systems thinking, interaction design, prototyping, information architecture, and cross-functional execution, as both a sole designer and within larger product teams.

SKILLS

Wireframing and prototyping (high- and low-fidelity) • Qualitative and quantitative user research • Formal and informal user testing • Card sorting, information architecture, and flow diagrams • Product design and design systems • Web design and front-end technologies • Automated data analytics • Agile workflow • Cross-functional stakeholder collaboration • Spanish and Italian language proficiency

TOOLS

Figma, Figma Make, Sketch, Adobe Creative Suite, Microsoft Copilot, UserTesting.com, Mixpanel, FullStory, HTML, CSS, JavaScript (and frameworks)

EXPERIENCE

Lead / Senior UX Designer — NCR | *Apr 2019 – Aug 2025*

- Served as sole designer for entirely new products (Mobile Pay, Aloha Update, CFC Web) owning the full design process end-to-end: led discovery meetings directly with product and engineering to define user needs and requirements, while balancing engineering constraints against ideal user experience.
- Collaborated on a very large team (4 designers, 4 product owners, 50+ developers) to launch a unified restaurant management experience for owners and operators that improved existing features and introduced new ones.
- Led design reviews with cross-functional stakeholders to validate technical and design feasibility.
- Designed a mobile-first contactless bill-pay and checkout experience for restaurant guests, plus a companion configuration tool for restaurant owners.
- Designed a mobile-first inventory-counting feature for restaurant staff to streamline in-store stock management.

UX Designer — Elavon | *May 2016 – Dec 2018*

- Collaborated with product owners, developers, and other stakeholders to design enterprise web-based SaaS products.
- Conducted qualitative research through questionnaires and semi-structured interviews, and quantitative research through task analysis and surveys.
- Translated research findings into actionable design recommendations to improve product usability and adoption.

Design / Development Intern — BitPay | *Jun 2015 – Aug 2015*

- Built transactional features in Node.js and designed and implemented web interfaces, both from scratch and on partially-complete codebases.
- Designed materials spanning motion, print, web, and installation.
- Supported customers directly, handling inbound calls and emails and helping resolve product issues.

Graduate Research Assistant — Georgia Tech GVU Center | *Sept 2010 – May 2016*

- Designed and produced posters, videos, animations, and physical installations, independently and in collaboration with research stakeholders, using industry-standard design and production tools.

UX Intern — Coca-Cola | *Summer 2013 & Summer 2014*

- Conceptualized and built data visualizations for social media performance metrics.
- Produced and animated short educational videos on emerging technologies.
- Advised on information architecture and feasibility for an internal web-based system.

EDUCATION

Georgia Tech — M.S., Human-Computer Interaction | 2016

Georgia Tech — M.S., Music Technology | 2014

Georgia Tech — B.S., Computational Media (Music), Honors | 2011